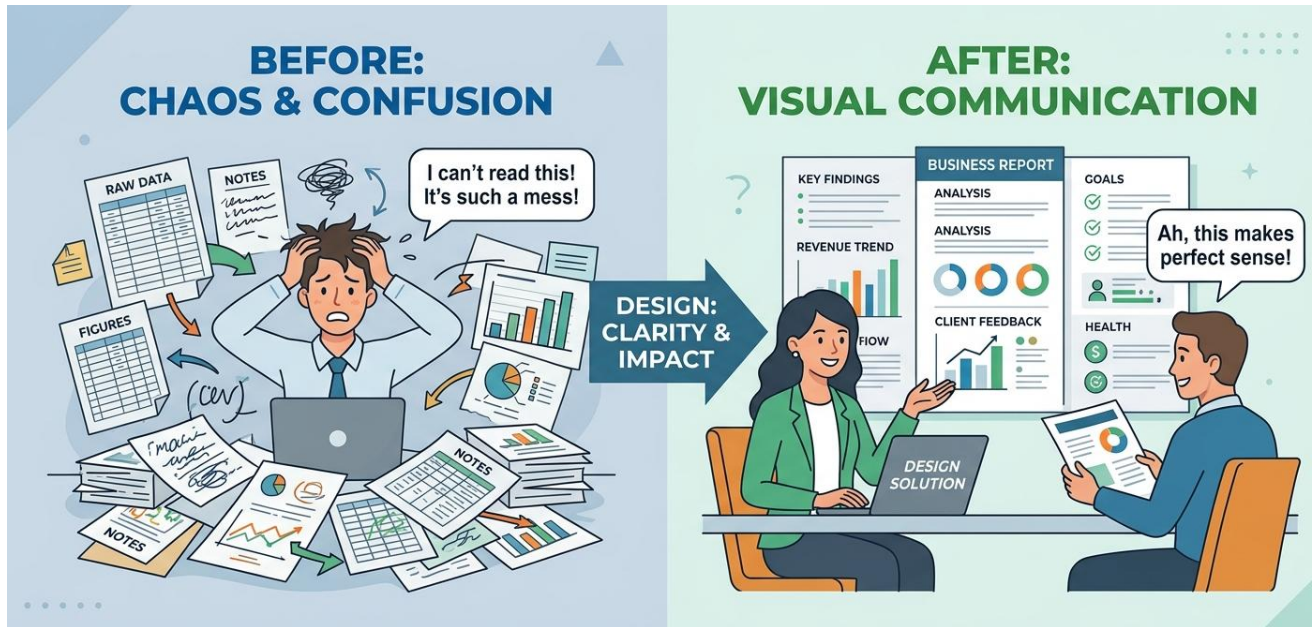

Session 20: Graphic Design 1: Visual Communication

Presented by

Ravindu Sooriyaarachchi

Canva

Design is NOT just making things "pretty."



Design is about Visual Communication.

If a boss hands you a messy report, your job is to make it easy for the client to read and understand.

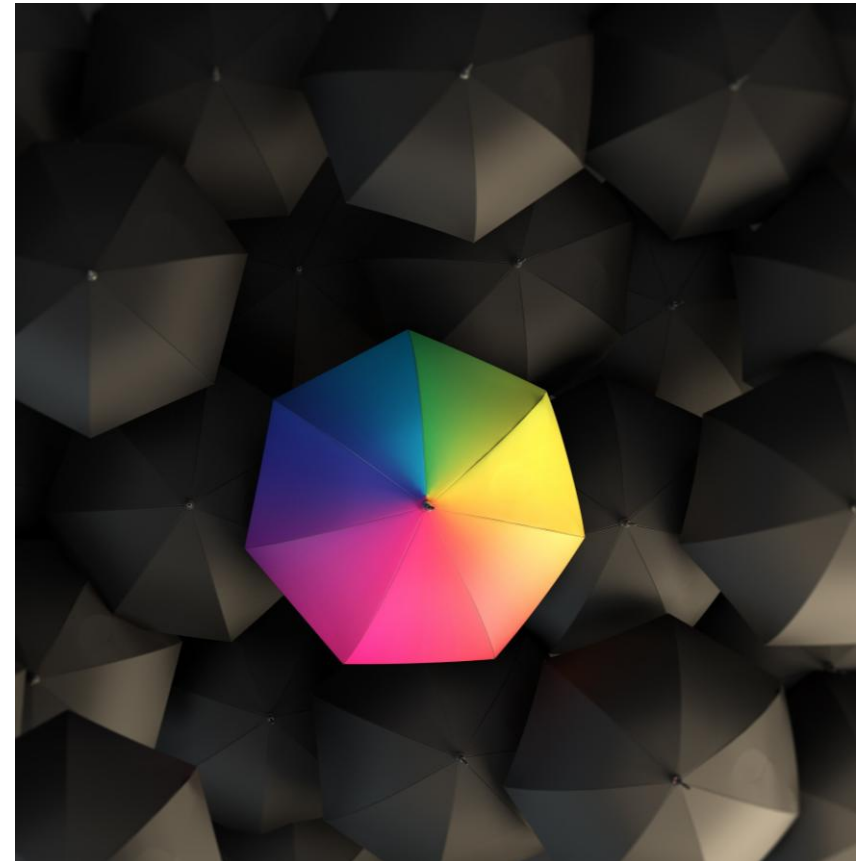
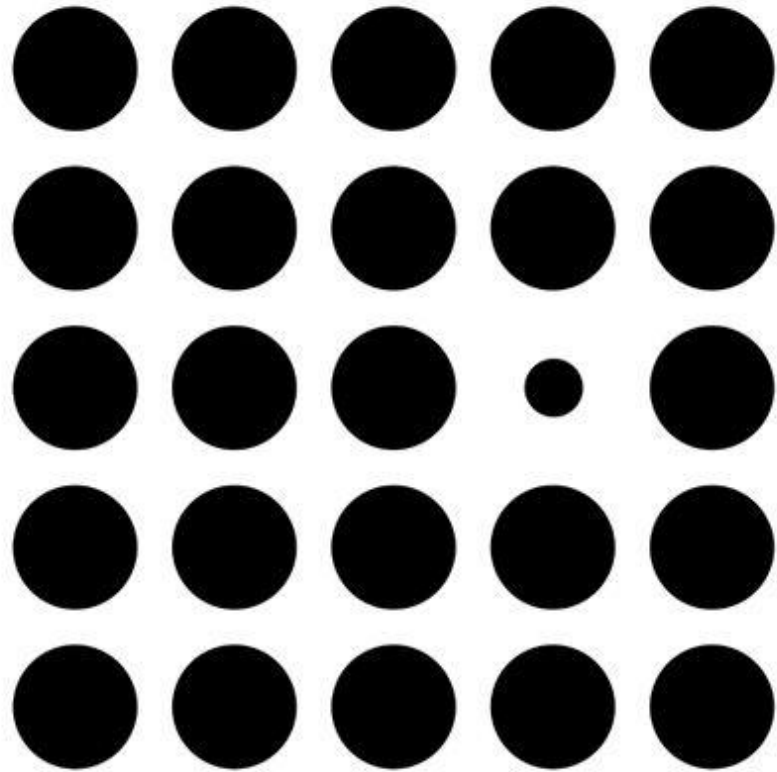
Good design solves problems; bad design creates confusion.



Contrast (Make it Pop!)



- If two items are not exactly the same, make them very different.
- **Color Contrast:** Dark text on a light background (or vice versa). Never use yellow text on a white background!
- **Size Contrast:** Make your main headline huge and your body text small. It tells the reader's eye where to look first.



Contrast

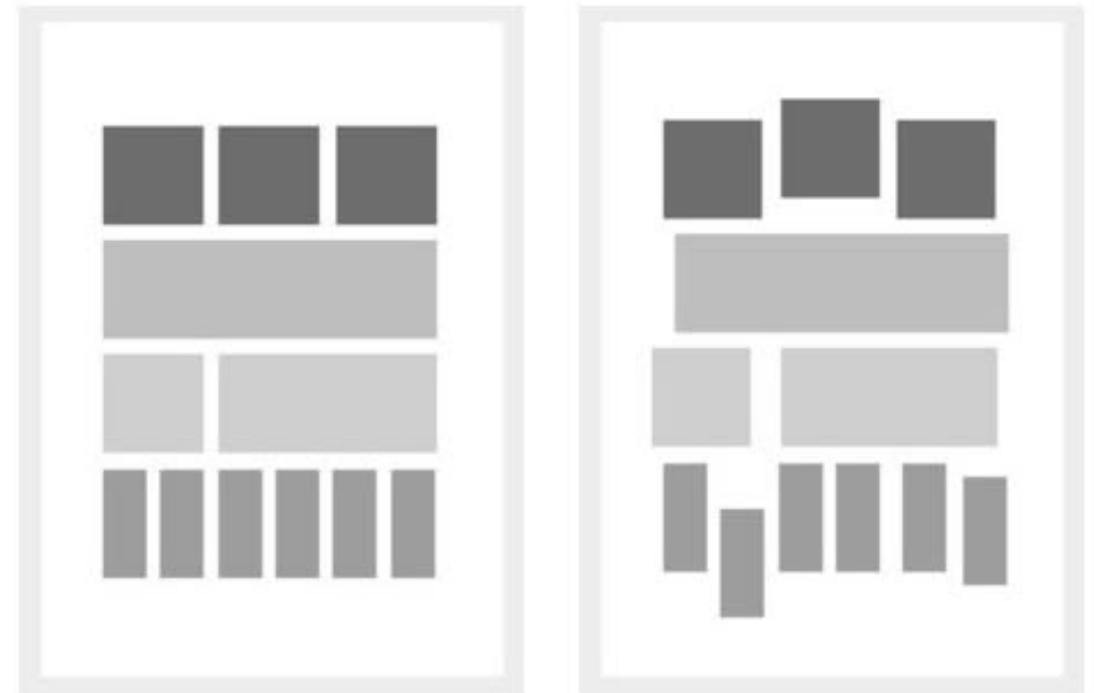
Repetition (Building a Brand)

- Repeat visual elements throughout your document.
- Use the exact same 2 fonts on every slide.
- Use the exact same 3 colors everywhere.
- Why? It creates consistency, which makes your work look like a professional "Brand" rather than a messy scrapbook.



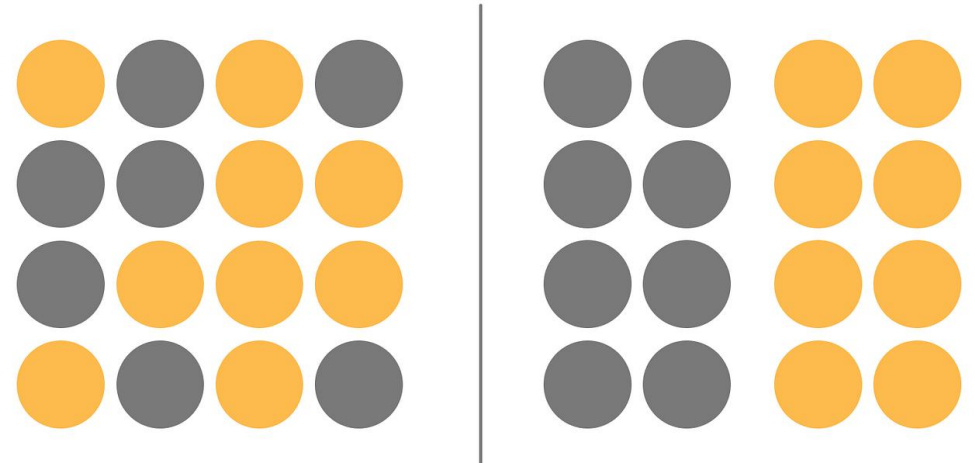
Alignment (The Invisible Grid)

- Nothing should be placed on the page randomly.
- Every item should have a visual connection with something else.
- **Pro Tip:** Left-aligned text usually looks much more professional and modern than Center-aligned text for corporate reports!



Proximity (Group Things Together)

- Items relating to each other should be grouped close together.
- If a photo belongs to a specific paragraph, move them right next to each other.
- Use "White Space" (empty space) to separate different topics so the page doesn't feel cluttered.



Full name

Street address

Email

Phone number

Occupation

Applied position

This form is difficult to perceive.

Full name

Street address

Email

Phone number

Occupation

Applied position

Now it is better.

Full name

Street address

Email

Phone number

Occupation

Applied position

The form looks much easier to fill out once we've separated personal data from job details.

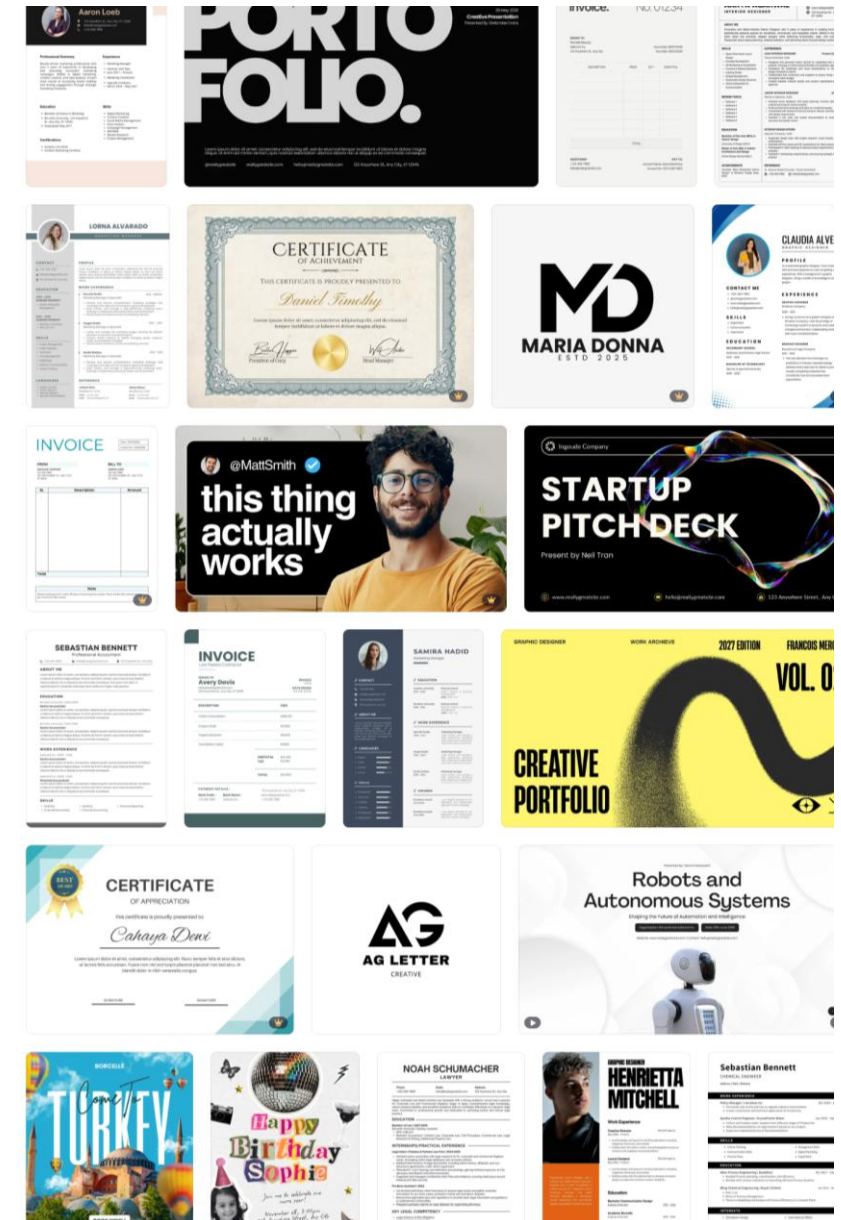
Meet Your New Best Friend: Canva

- **What is it?** A free, browser-based professional design tool (www.canva.com).
- **Why use it?** No installation, works on any laptop, saves to the cloud automatically, and is highly requested by modern employers.

The Canva logo is displayed in a white, elegant script font. It is centered horizontally and positioned in the upper half of a large rectangular area with a vertical gradient background that transitions from a bright cyan at the top to a deep purple at the bottom.

Beware the Template Trap

- Canva has thousands of beautiful templates.
- **The Problem:** When non-designers change the text or add their own photos, they accidentally break the Alignment and Contrast, making the template look terrible.
- **The Solution:** Always use the 4 Golden Rules to double-check your work, even if you started with a template!



Activity: The Slide Makeover

- The Mission: The instructor made a terrible, messy presentation slide. It is your job to fix it.

Step 1: Go to Canva.com and click "Create a Design" → "Presentation (16:9)".

Step 2: Look at the messy slide provided by the instructor.

Step 3: Rebuild the information on that slide using Canva.

- Rule: You MUST use Contrast, Repetition, Alignment, and Proximity to make it look like a professional corporate slide!



Send Me Your Thoughts (Anonymously!)

*Scan the QR code and share your
questions or feedback*

<https://forms.gle/oKg7kAJNLI3Gcv7n7>

Thank You!

